



Image source: Wikipedia

Figure 1: An application of augmented reality

the building, you point it to a different building and it says it's a non-veg restaurant. Further down the road you see another building marked as a "theater". Now, that is what is augmented reality. Such an app would really be enhancing your perception of reality; it would add information to your reality - it would augment reality.

Another example for visual augmentation would be glasses which tell you the direction in which you are looking. If you are looking towards east, it shows on screen what you are seeing (of course) and in addition, tells you that



Figure 2: Augmented reality is not a distant future anymore

you are looking in the 'east' direction (if that is the direction you were facing). This information is displayed on the transparent glass. You turn right by 90 degrees and it would say that you are now facing south. Add 'night vision' view to those glasses and